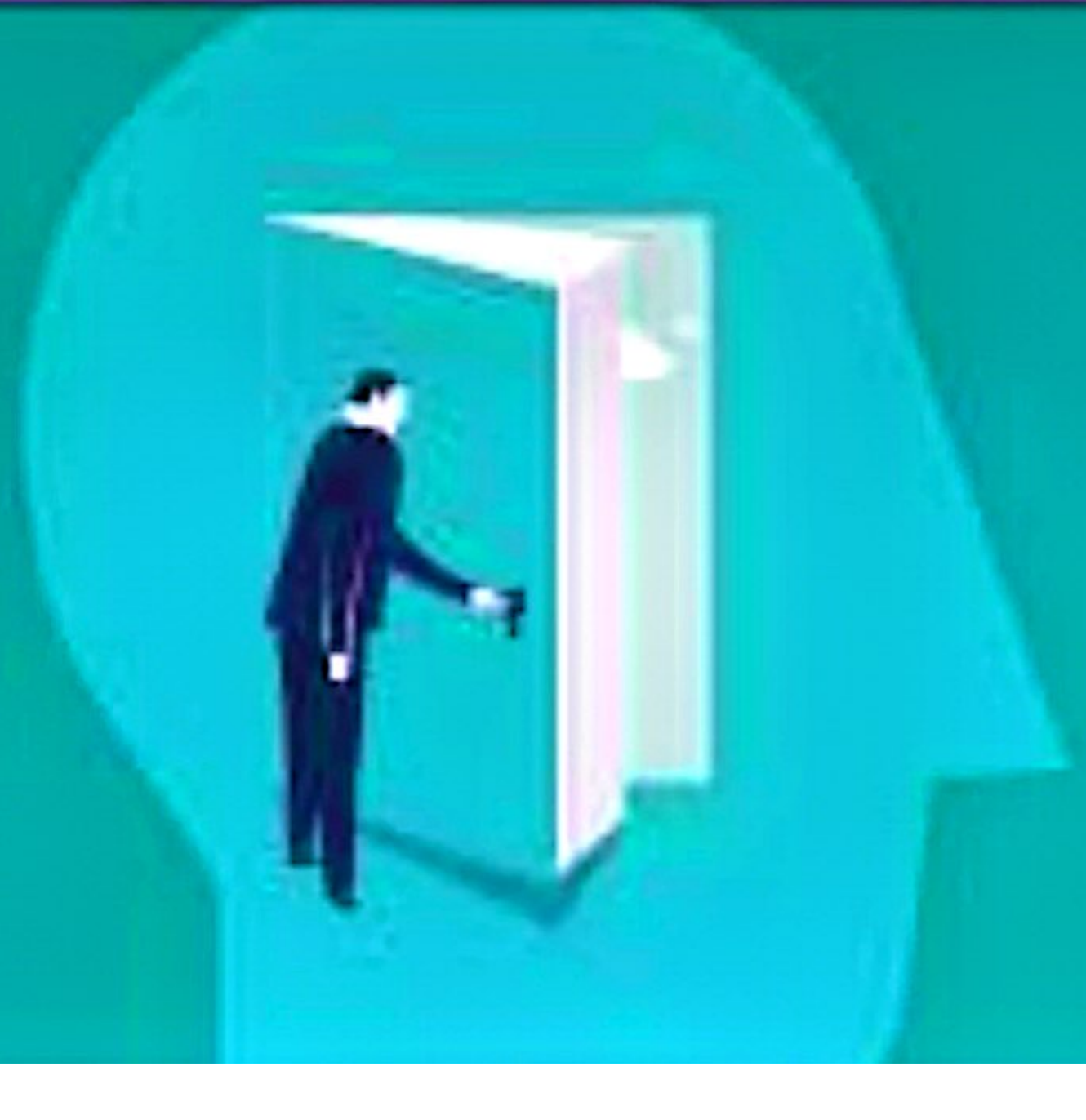
School of Thoughts in Psychology



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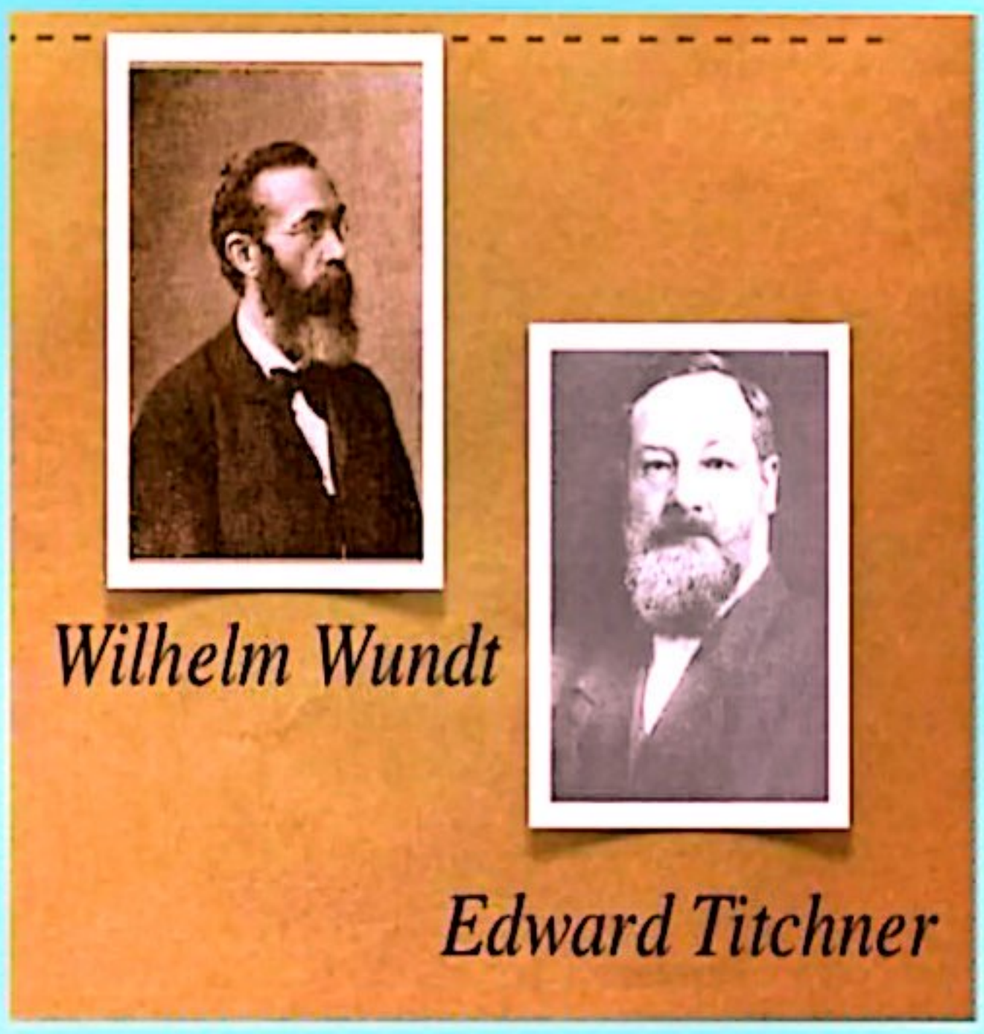
Schools of Thoughts in Psychology

- Structuralism
- Functionalism
- Behaviorism
- Cognitivism
- Gestalt
- Humanism
- Psychoanalytic

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Structuralism

- Structuralism was the first school of psychology, and fovused on breaking down mental processes into the most basic components
- **Wilhelm Wundt the father of structuralism, opened the world's first psychological laboratory in Leipzig in** 1879
- **Edward Titchner, Weber and Fechner are some of the notable structuralists.**



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Structuralism

- Based on introspection
- Immediate experiences of human beings
- Holds that psychological wholes are compounds of elements
- The main elements are sensations , feelings , images and the like that form conscious experience.
- Aim of psychology is to study mental element
- Systematic observation of the activities of mind

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Contributions

- It separated psychology from philosophy and metaphysics and developed it as an independent and organized discipline.
- It emphasized the systematic observation of the activities of learners under controlled learning conditions.
- It gives an experimental method for studying human behavior, ie, experimental introspection.
- It initiated a spirit of science and experimentation in the field of education.

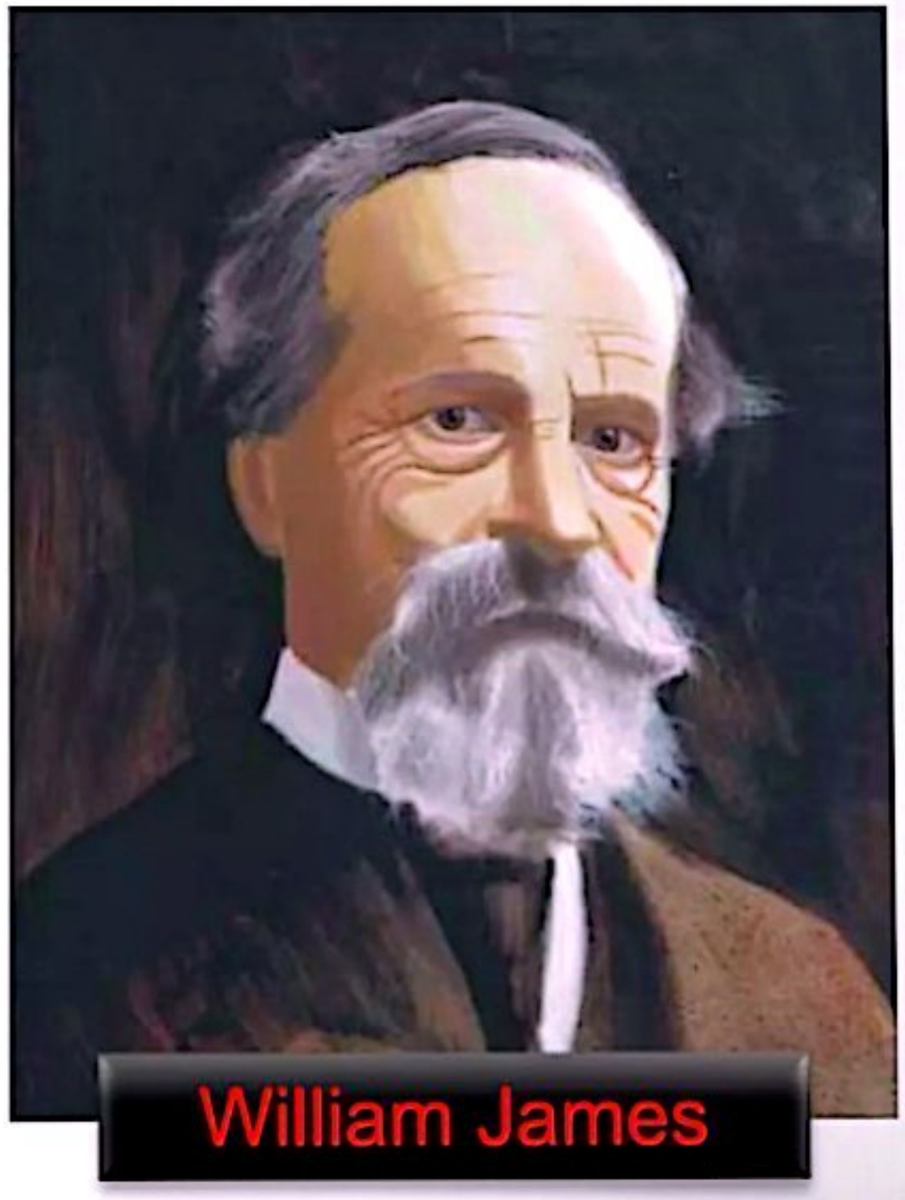
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Limitations

- Experimental introspection method – it is unreliable, limiting and subjective.
- It is based on internal behavior which cannot be observed directly.
- It cannot be employed to study behaviour of children, the mentally defective, insane humans animals.

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Functionalism formed as a reaction to the theories of the structuralist school of thought and was heavily influenced by the work of William James, father of American psychology.


William James

Functionalism

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Functionalism

- Functionalism studies mind as it functions in adapting the individual to his environment.
- The school flourished in the universities of Chicago and Columbia in America and two different streams came into existence – the Columbia functionalism and the Chicago functionalism.
- The important among the Chicago functionalists were John Dewey, Angell, and Harvey Carr. The Columbia functionalists includes Thorndike, Cattell and Woodworth



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TENETS OF FUNCTIONALISM

- According to functionalism the aims of psychology is the study of what for and what of mental process.
- It emphasizes with the nature and functi of mental processes.
- Functionalism considers mind to be a recent development towards adjustment to his environment
- They believed that the mind and body are intrinsically one. The mental activities are the result of adjustment between the mind and the body.



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Contributions to Education

- It included curriculum with subjects having practical utility.
- It emphasized study of various problems of the learner and their solution.
- It give importance to learning by doing and developed activity oriented methods like project method for teaching and learning.
- It emphasized child-centered learning.

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Limitations of Functionalism

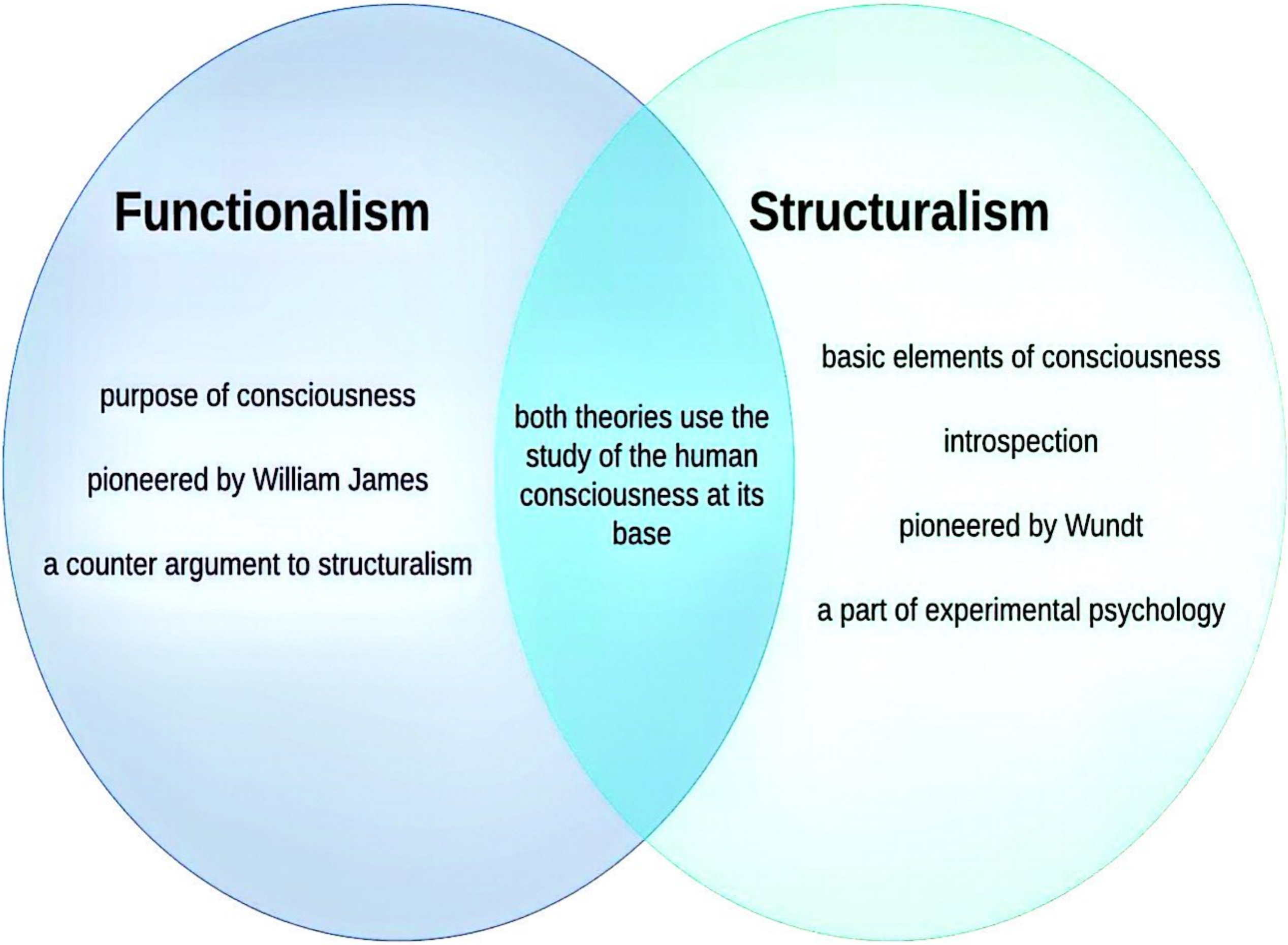
- The term function is variously used by functionalists and they failed to define many psychological concepts.
- It is teleological (it holds that mind functions to achieve some purpose) and eclectic.
- Like structuralists, functionalists also focused only on consciousness and neglected the unconscious facets of human mind.
- It only aid man's adjustment to environment is highly biological and neglected socio – cultural influences in the functioning of mind.

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STRUCTURALISM
VERSUS
FUNCTIONALISM

STRUCTURALISM	FUNCTIONALISM
Structuralism is known to be a part of experimental psychology	Functionalism was introduced as a counter argument to structuralism
Focuses on different brain elements and their capacities	Focuses on the adaptations of human mind to different environments

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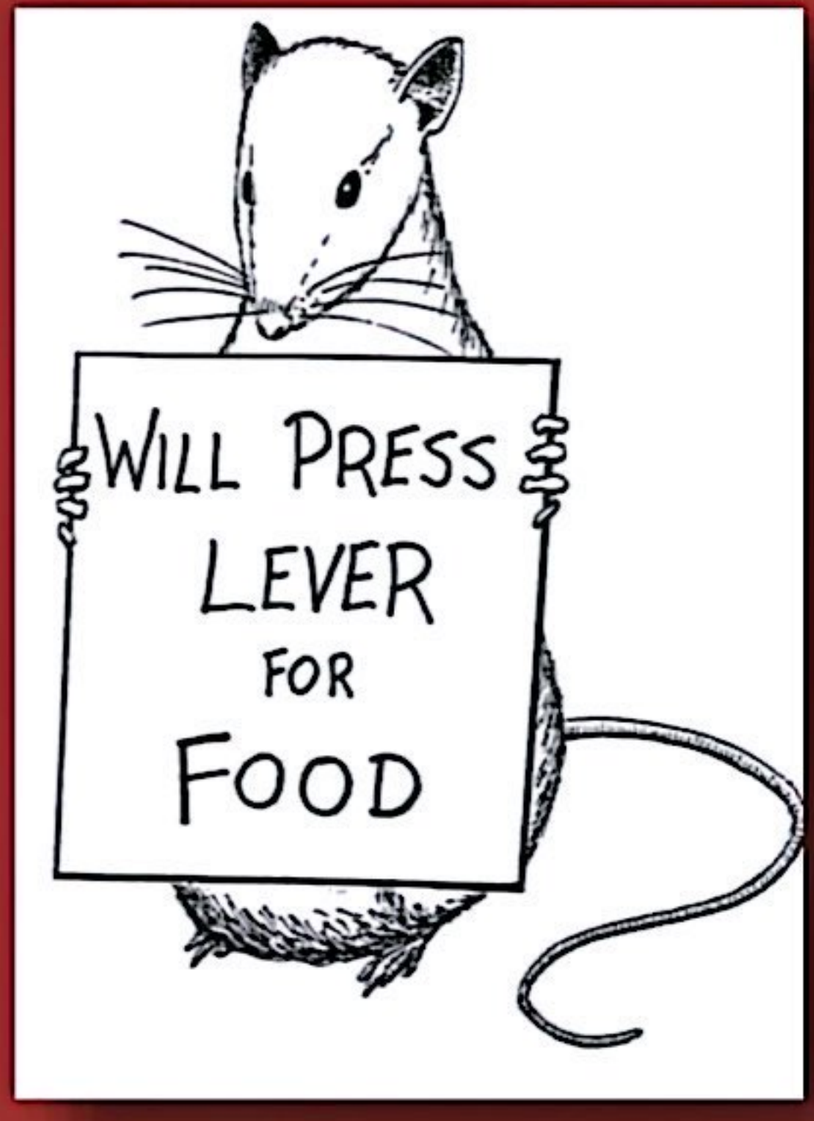
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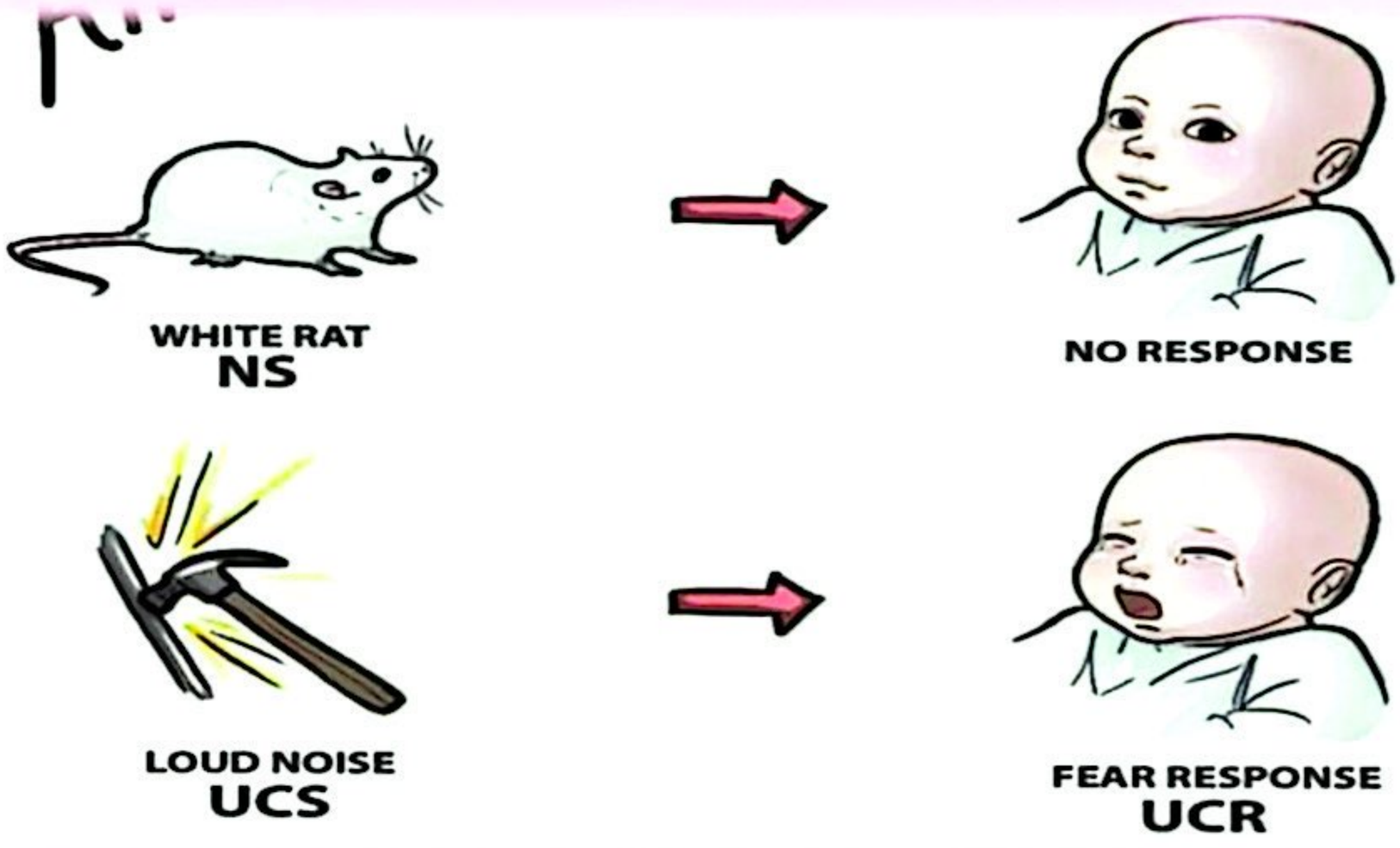
Behaviorism

- Behaviorism become the dominant school of thought during the 1950's.
- J.B.Watson, an American psychologist, is the founder of the behaviourist school which came into existence as a protest against structuralism and functionalism.
- Other notable psychologists of this school were Skinner, Pavlov, Tolman, Hull etc



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- According to the behaviourist school is a purely experimental branch of the natural science, the object of which is to elaborate, control and predict behaviour.



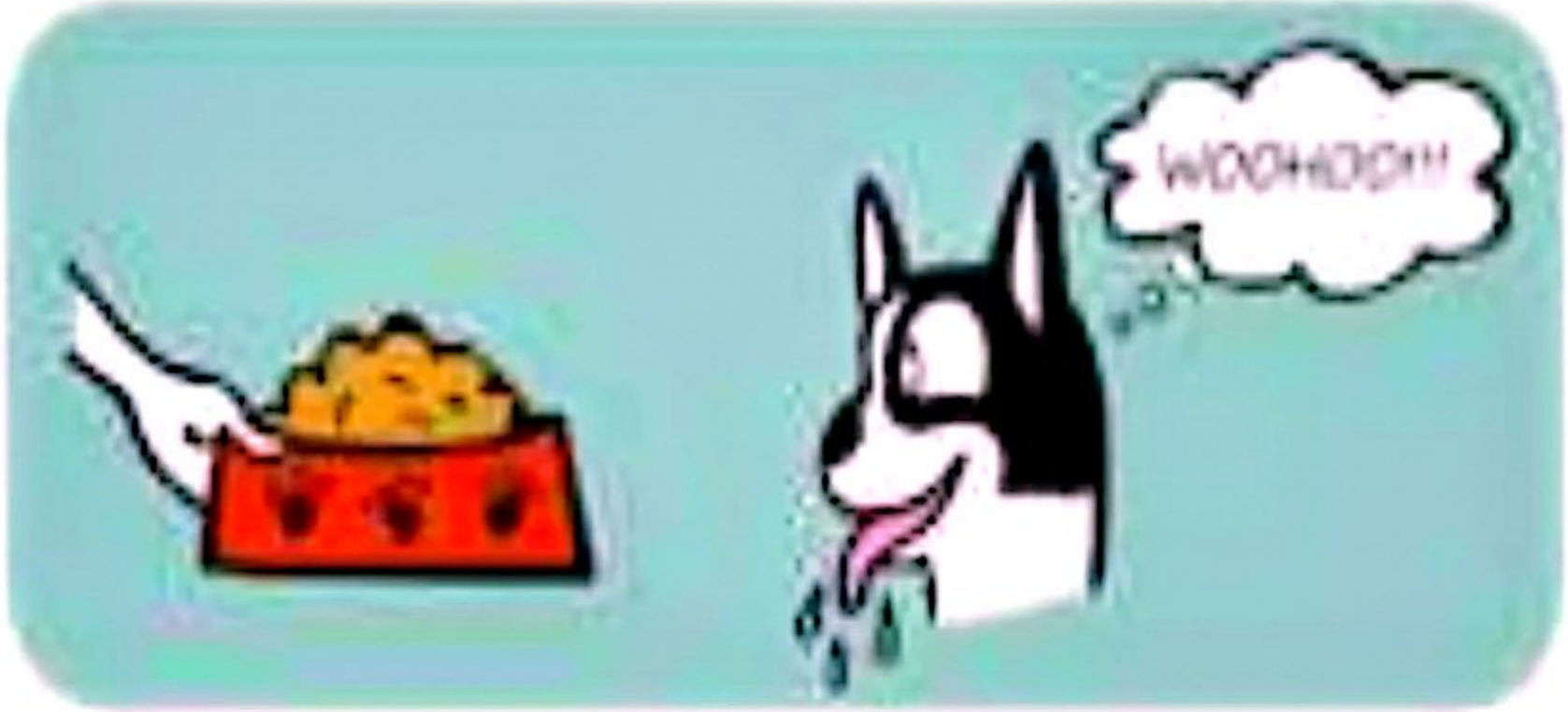
TENETS OF BEHAVIORISM

- Psychology is the science of stimulus and response, it is concerned with the study of receptors (sense-organs) and effectors (muscles and nerves).
- The chief task of psychology is to study the overt or observable behaviour that can be measured scientifically.
- Behaviour is merely the response to some environmental stimulus. It is an association of stimulus and response.



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- Environmental forces are more important in determining the behaviour and shaping the personality of an individual.
- All behaviour is learnt in the process of interaction with environment.



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Contribution to Education

- Behaviourism advocated the use of reinforcement in the place of punishment.
- Programmed learning
- The techniques of shaping behaviour and the behaviour modification programmes advocted by the behaviourists.
- Contributed a lot in dealing with backward and maladjusted children in the classroom.

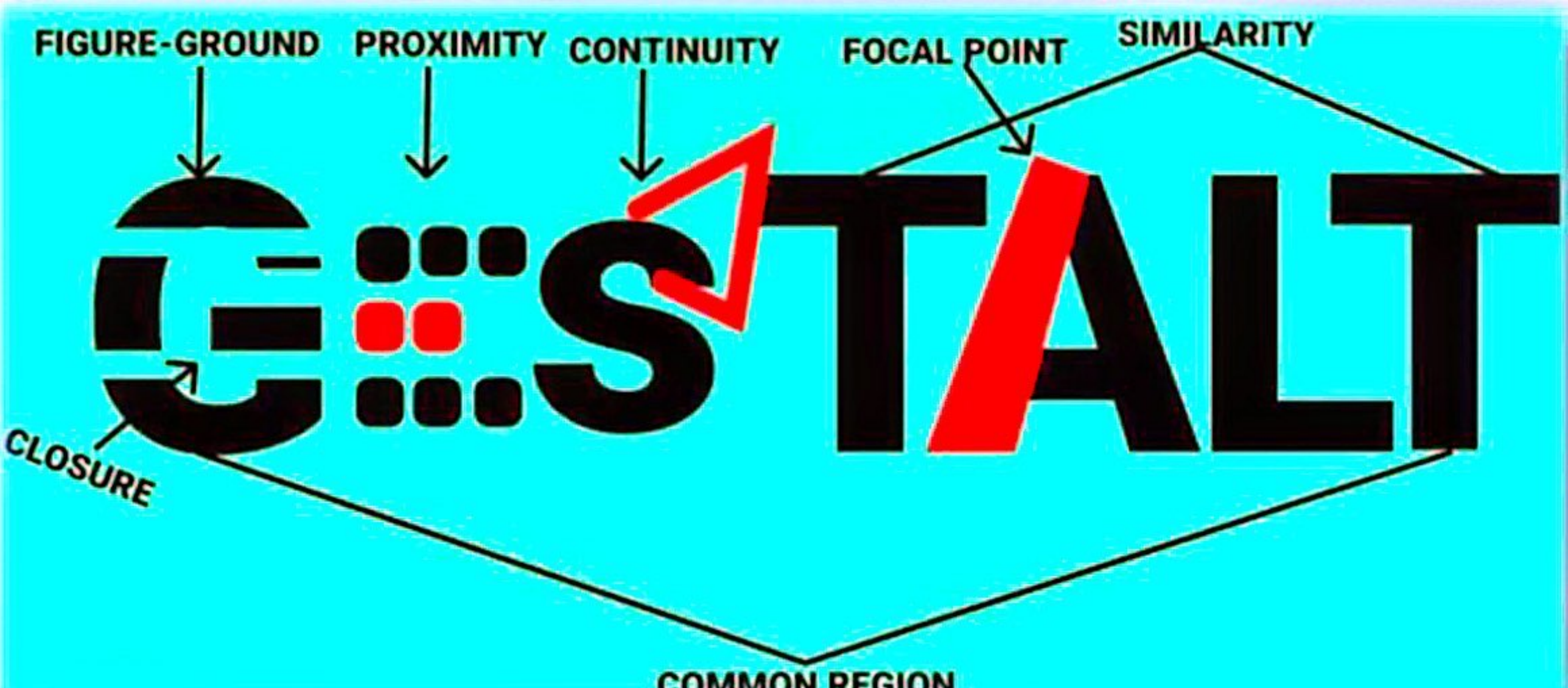


Limitations of Behaviourism

- Human behaviour is so complex that it cannot be studied by breaking down into simple response connections as held by behaviourists.
- It focused totally on the overt or observable behaviour of man and neglected the convert.
- They give importance to the environment in shaping human behaviour and neglected the role of heredity.

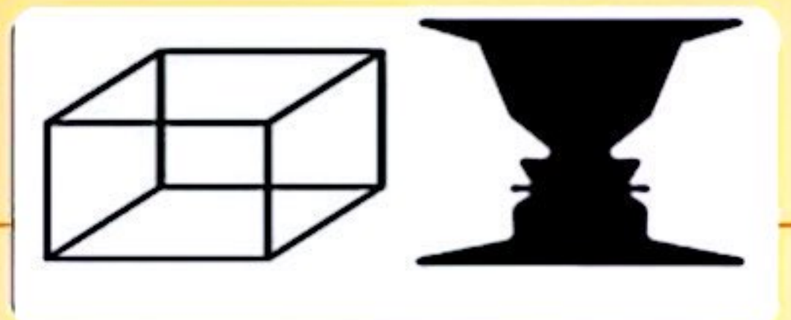


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GESTALT PSYCHOLOGY

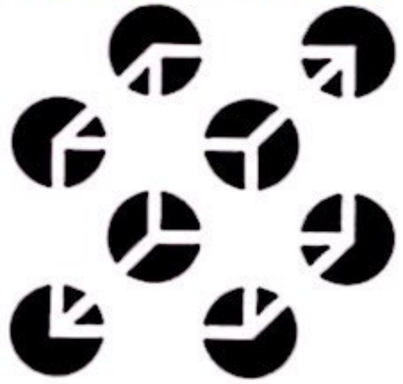


- Gestalt Psychology was born in Germany and it was founded by Max Wertheimer.
- Major proponents of this school is Kurt Koffka, Wolfgang Kohler and Kurt Lewin.
- Gestalt is a German word, which means configuration or organised whole.
- Gestalt psychologists emphasized the role of configuration or organization in the perceptual field and highlight the role of insight and understanding in learning

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Tenets of Gestalt Psychology

- The whole is greater than the sum of its parts. It is the whole which determines the behaviour of its parts.
- An individual perceives a thing as a whole and not as a mere collection of its constituents or elements.
- Perception always involves a problem of organization.



- Learning takes place as a result of organization of the perceptual field by the learner in a meaningful and intelligent way.

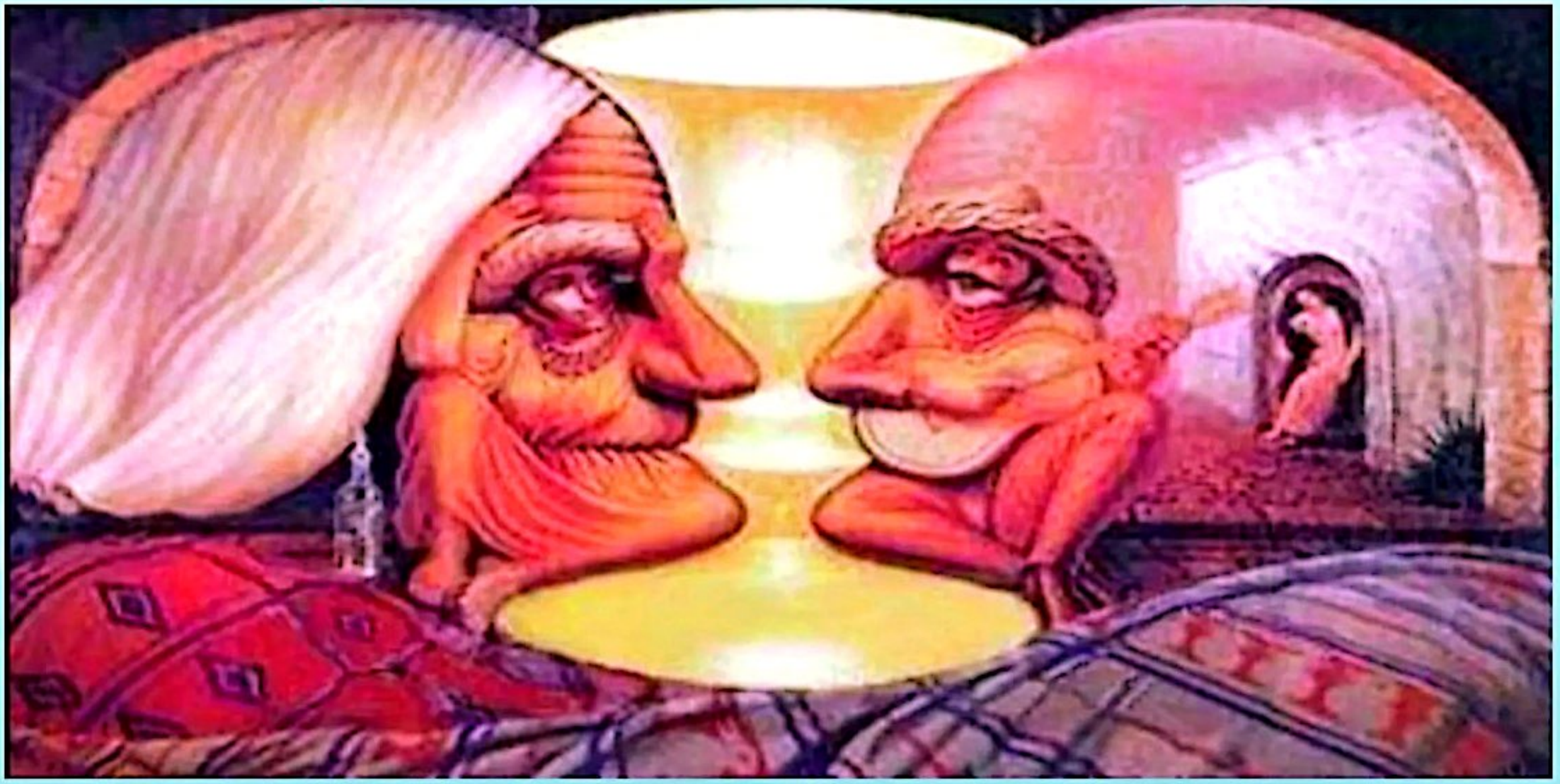
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Contribution to Education

- **Gestalt school emphasized the important of presenting the subject matter as a whole in the class so as to make learning more meaningful.**
- Gestalt principles have found its application in the construction of curriculum, organization of syllabus, scheme of studies, work-plan etc.
- Hoslistic methods of teaching, holistic evaluation, insight learning, interdisciplinary approach to the study of problems, comprehensive educational programmes etc. draw their inspiration from the Gestalt school.

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- Gestaltists emphasized that learning of generalizations, laws, principles and theories enable the students to apply the acquired knowledge in a new situation.



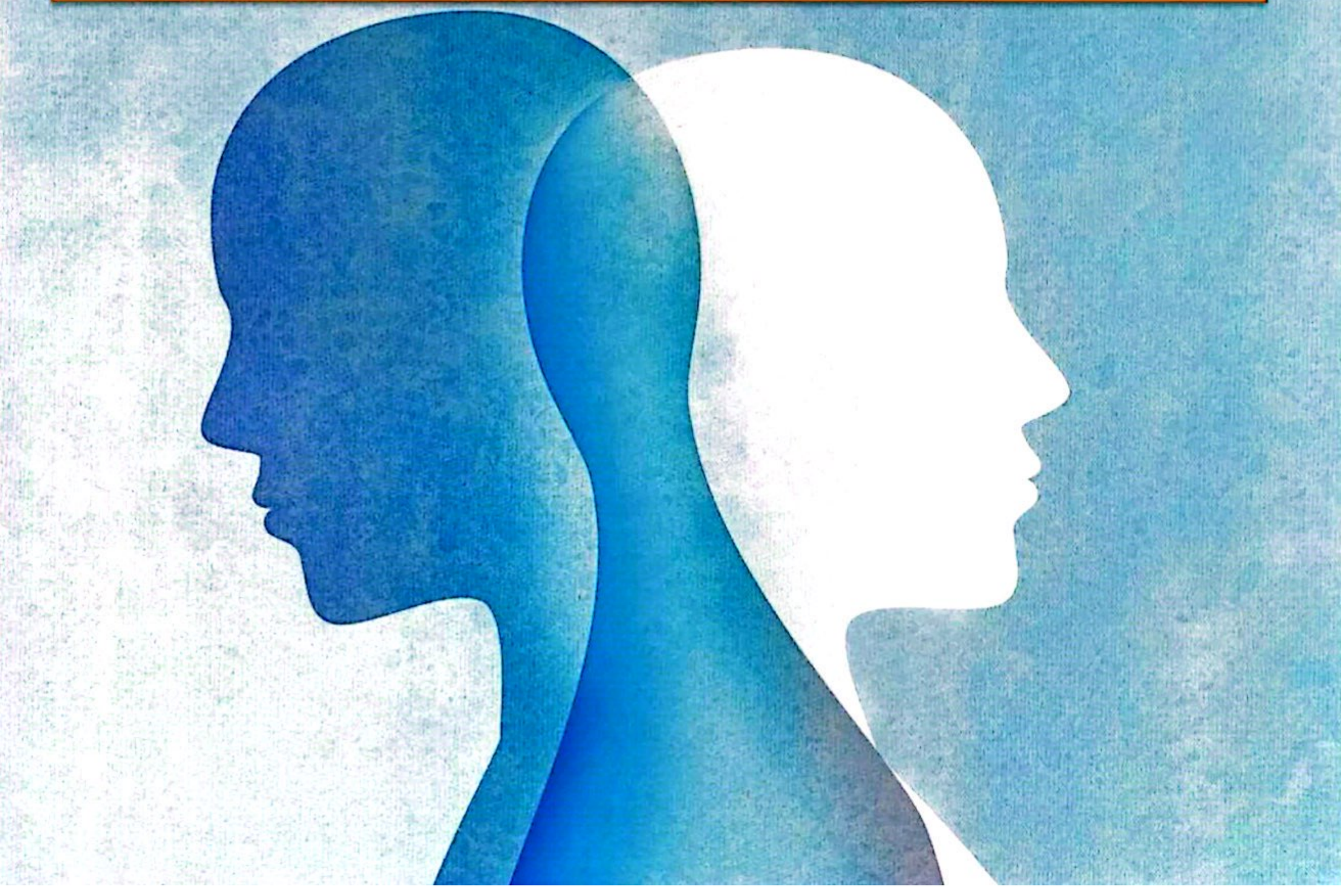
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Limitations of Gestaltism

- It failed to explain learning beyond perceptual experience.
- It failed to explain the strengthening of behaviour through practice.
- It could not fully explain how previous experience influence learning.
- In many occasions learning takes place by trial and error. Gestalists failed to explain this.

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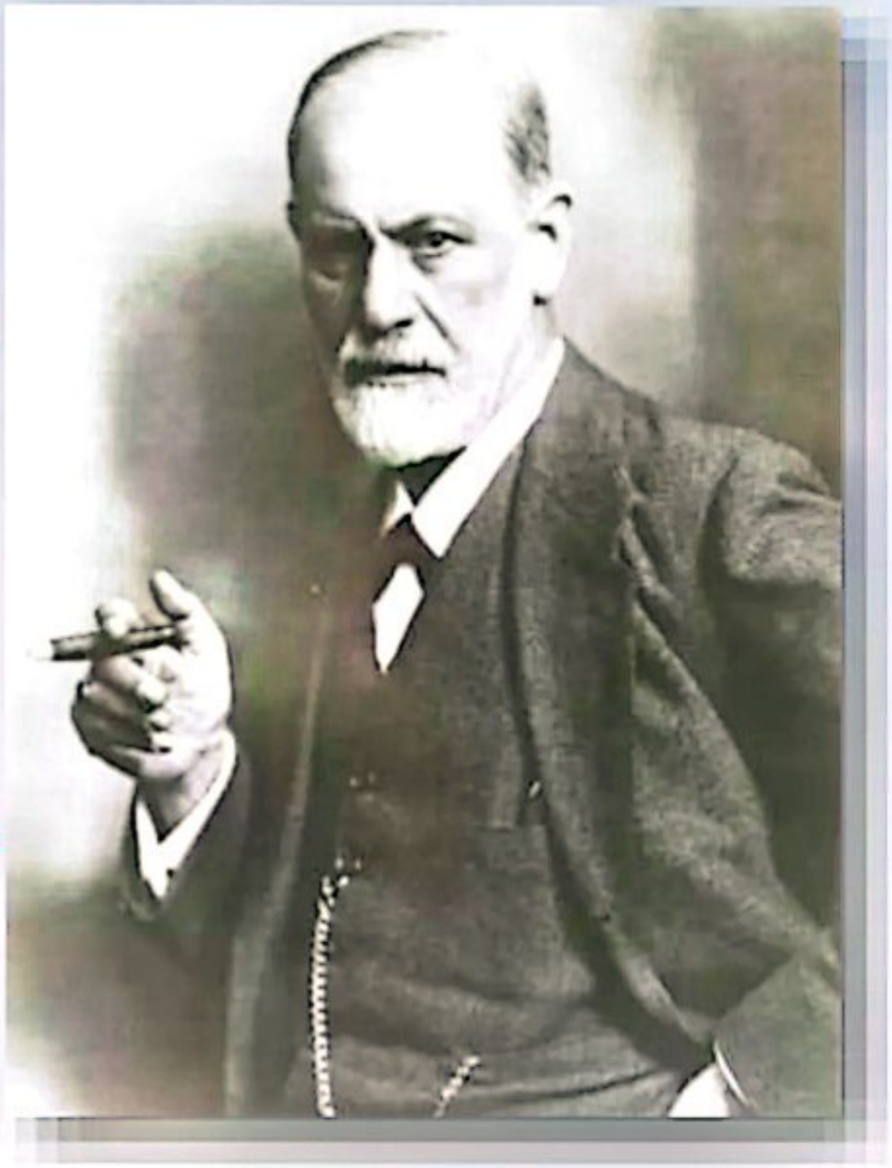
Psychoanalysis



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Psychoanalysis

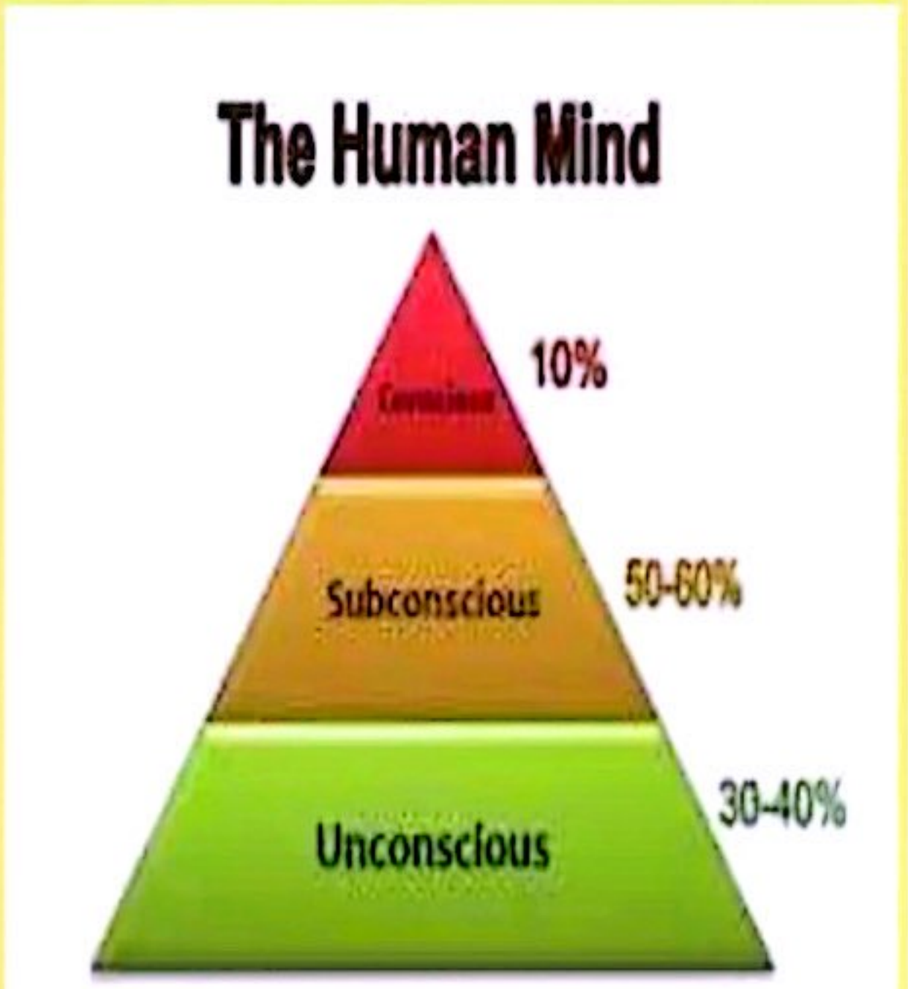
- It is associated with the name of Sigmund Freud, a Viennese neurologist, who stressed the study of human behaviour through the analysis of unconscious mental process by using the method of free association and dream analysis.
- Important personalities who contributed to this school are Adler, Jung, Hartmann, Erickson, Anna Freud (daughter of Sigmund Freud) etc



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Tenets of Psychoanalysis

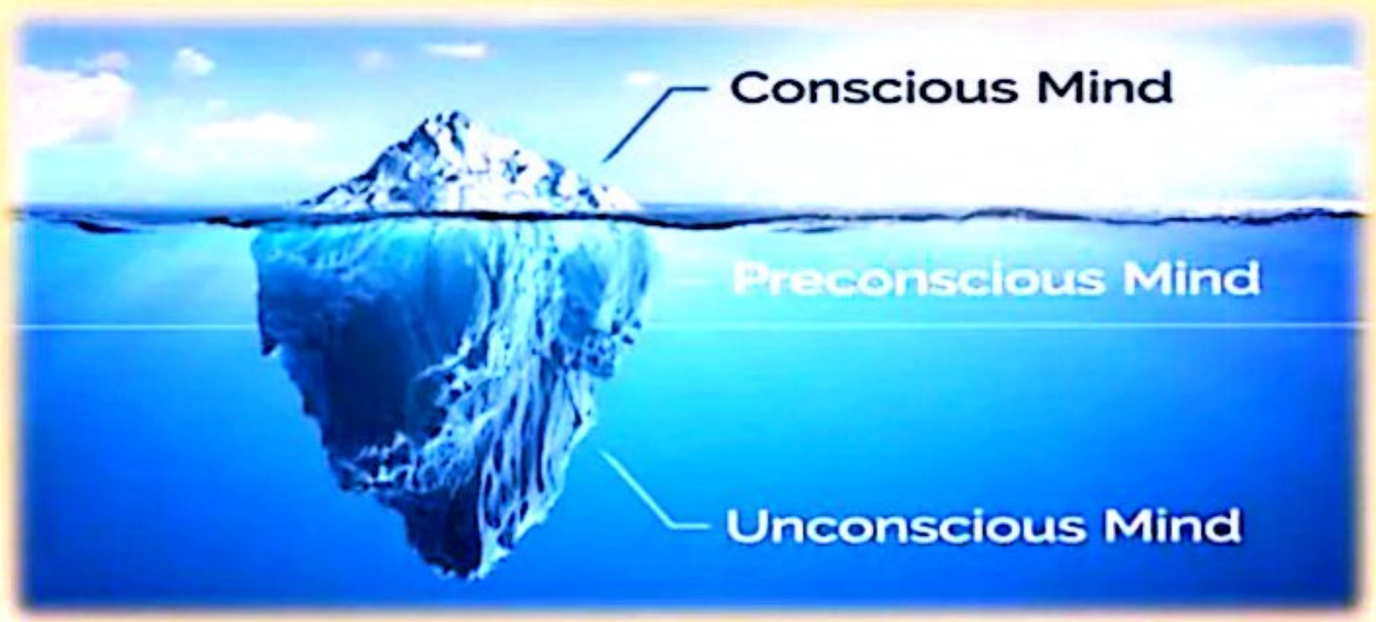
- Human mind has three parts – Conscious, Sub-conscious and unconscious.
- The unconscious layer constitute the larger part of mental life which contains all the repressed wishes, desires, feelings, drives, motives, etc.



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Tenets of Psychoanalysis

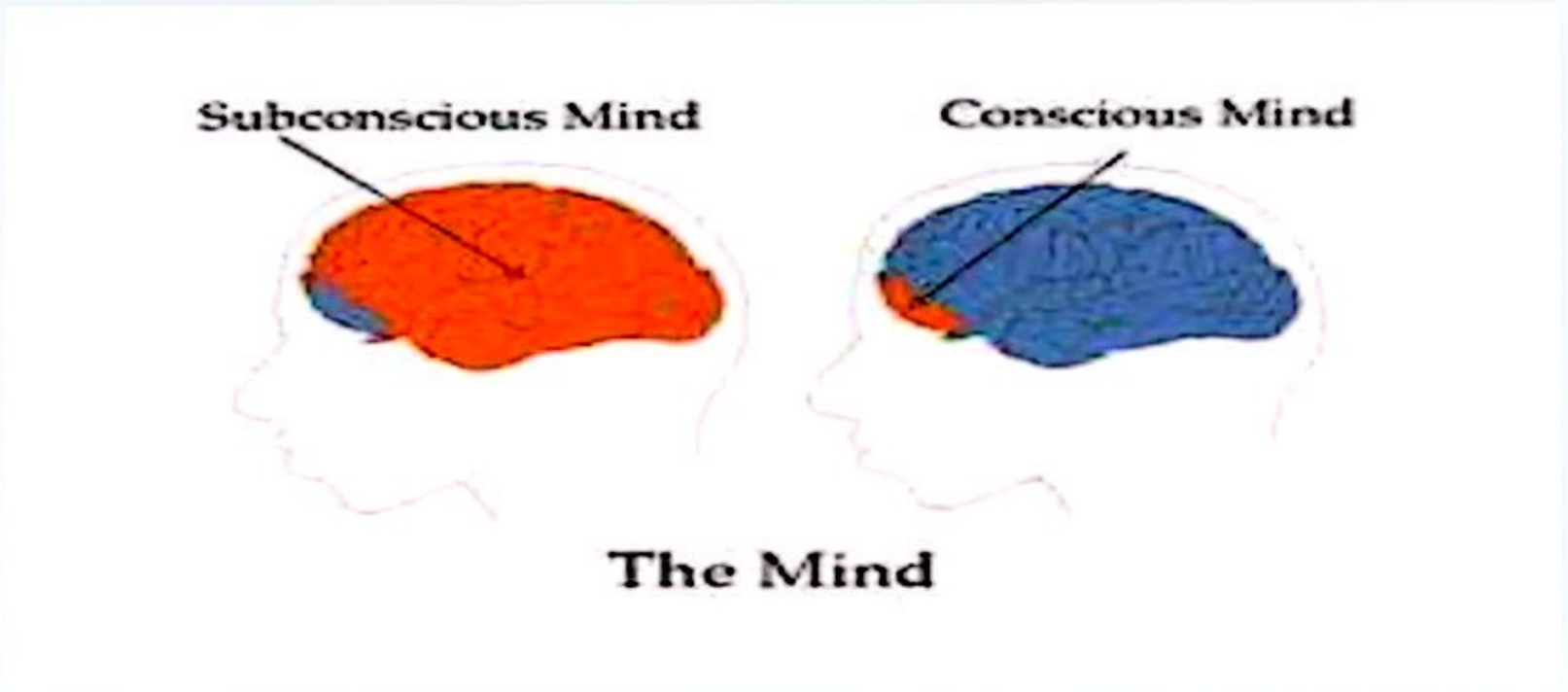
- Id (instinctive desires), ego (reason based on real experience) and Super-ego (moral inhibition) are the three aspects of our complete self or personality.
- Human behaviour and personality are the result of adaptation of real physical and social world, but the core of personality remains what was laid down in childhood.



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Contribution to Education

- Freud discovered unconscious motivation which plays an important role in the process of learning.
- Psycho-analysis has emphasized the importance of the early experiences of the child in the process of education.



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Contribution to Education

- It stressed the importance of feelings and emotions in the process of education.
- It has thrown light on the causes of maladjustment and behavioral problems in children.



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Limitations of Psychoanalysis

- Freudian concepts like id, ego, superego, etc are hypothetical construct which lack any scientific support.
- Psycho analytical school over emphasized sexual world and neglected social experience in the formation of personality.
- It does not permit inferences about cause and effect.
- Freud adopted non-scientific



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